

THE WHITE HOUSE

WASHINGTON

INTELLIGENCE MEMORANDUM

DATE: March 9th, 2026

FROM: Megan Fife

SOURCES: [The Quantum Insider](#), [Next Gov](#)

TOPIC: Executive Order Draft Preparing for Q-Day

ISSUE: An Executive Order is being drafted to update the National Quantum Initiative from 2018 titled, “Ushering In The Next Frontier Of Quantum Innovation.” This coordinates inter-agency contingency plans for various quantum threats.

BACKGROUND: This order calls for the creation of contingency plans to restructure various governmental agencies’ approach to quantum technological threats. By coordinating and accelerating quantum discoveries, the U.S. will move them from primarily lab research to real world national security applications to remain competitive and protect our supply chains. The Office of Science and Technology Policy (OSTP) will direct America’s quantum future by having Energy, Defense and Commerce agencies execute the vision. Outlines of agency specific plans will be drafted in response to quantum threats with the recommendation to create optimal conditions for the private sector to develop and invest in these technologies. After 30 days, agencies will report to the OSTP and the Office of Management and Budget and after 180, the National Quantum Initiative Advisory Committee will be reestablished by the OSTP director. The committee expired in 2023 but was originally established by the 2018 National Quantum Initiative Act signed by President Trump but does not appropriately address recent private investment in quantum technology and increased global competition. The FBI Director will focus on U.S. cryptographic capabilities using their Quantum Information Science and Technology Counterintelligence Protection Team, while the DNI focuses on resource and budgetary concerns. The International Trade Administration will outline barriers in foreign trade and domestic practices or policies that limit our quantum capabilities.

ANALYSIS: Traditional computers use 0 or 1 while Quantum computers use qubits which can be 0 and 1 and everything in between, accelerating computing time and utilizing different encryption methods. Popular media refers to a quantum day or Q-Day that will happen over a period of time, with effects felt in 2029, when public encryption methods are broken. Various private investment in this technology has made it possible for consumer use soon which will increase the number of potential hackers and security

risks to the U.S. An executive order is a step in the right direction as this is an imminent threat.